

Recruiter Cold Outreach — 50 Cold Outreach Prompts + Bonus Sequences

General

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Bonus: Follow-Up Email Sequences

Recruiter Cold Outreach Follow-Up Email Sequences

Sequence 1: After No Reply to Initial Outreach

Email 1 (Day 3): Subject: Still thinking about [Company Name]'s hiring needs

Hi [First Name],

I reached out a few days ago about helping [Company Name] source top-tier talent, but I know inboxes get busy fast.

I wanted to resurface because I've been working with companies in [their industry] to cut time-to-hire by an average of 34% while improving candidate quality. Given that you're [mention a relevant trigger — scaling, recently funded, opened a new office], I thought the timing might make sense.

Here's the quick version of what I do differently:

- ****Pre-vetted candidates only**** — you never see a resume that hasn't passed my screening process
- ****7-day average to first qualified interview**** — not weeks
- ****Replacement guarantee**** — if a placement doesn't work out in 90 days, I re-fill the role at no cost

If you're currently trying to fill any roles — or anticipate headcount growth in the next quarter — I'd love a 15-minute conversation to see if there's a fit.

Would Thursday or Friday work for a quick call?

Best,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 2 (Day 7): Subject: Quick question about your current team

Hi [First Name],

I'll keep this one short.

Are you currently struggling with any of these?

- Roles that have been open for 60+ days
- A flood of unqualified applicants eating up your team's time
- Losing strong candidates to competitors who move faster

If yes to any of the above, I have a few ideas that could help — and I can usually show results within the first two weeks of working together.

If the timing just isn't right, no worries at all. A simple "not now" is genuinely helpful so I can follow up when it makes more sense.

Either way, what's your current situation with hiring?

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 3 (Day 14): Subject: Closing the loop — [Company Name]

Hi [First Name],

I don't want to keep cluttering your inbox, so this will be my last note for now.

Before I go, I wanted to leave you with something useful.

[Attach or link a relevant resource — e.g., "I put together a short guide on the 5 interview mistakes that cause candidates to ghost companies in [their industry]." or mention a relevant case study.]

If you ever find yourself hitting a wall with a specific role or just want a second opinion on your recruiting strategy, my calendar is always open.

You can book a no-pressure 15-minute call here: [Calendly link]

Take care, and I hope to connect at a better time.

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

P.S. If someone else on your team handles hiring decisions, I'd really appreciate a quick redirect. Happy to reach out directly so I'm not wasting your time.

Sequence 2: After a Positive Initial Response

Email 1 (Day 1): Subject: Great connecting — here's what I promised

Hi [First Name],

Thanks so much for getting back to me — I really appreciate it.

As promised, here's a quick summary of how I typically work with companies like [Company Name]:

****Step 1 — Discovery (Day 1-2):**** We spend 30 minutes getting crystal clear on your ideal candidate profile, culture fit, compensation range, and must-haves vs. nice-to-haves.

****Step 2 — Active Search (Days 3-7):**** I tap into my existing network and run a targeted outreach campaign to passive candidates who match your criteria.

****Step 3 — Curated Shortlist (Day 7-10):**** You receive a shortlist of 3-5 pre-vetted candidates with detailed profiles, not just resumes.

****Step 4 — Interview Coordination:**** I manage scheduling, prep candidates, and keep communication flowing on both sides.

I've attached [a case study / one-pager] showing how I helped [Similar Company] hire a [similar role] in 11 days.

To get started, I'd love to schedule that discovery call we mentioned. Here's my calendar: [Calendly link]

Looking forward to it,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 2 (Day 3): Subject: One more thing before our call

Hi [First Name],

Quick note ahead of our upcoming conversation.

To make our time as valuable as possible, it would help me to know a little more upfront. Would you mind sharing:

1. ****Which role(s) are your highest priority**** to fill right now?
2. ****How long**** have those positions been open?
3. ****What's been your biggest frustration**** with the hiring process so far — volume, quality, speed?

No pressure to have polished answers. Even a quick reply helps me come to our call with specific ideas rather than generic suggestions.

Also — if you'd like to include anyone else from your team (HR, hiring manager, department head), feel free to forward this along. The more context I have, the better I can serve you.

See you soon,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 3 (Day 6 — if no confirmation or pre-call info received): Subject: Still on for [Day/Time]?

Hi [First Name],

Just circling back to confirm we're still good for [Day, Date] at [Time].

I've been doing a little prep work on my end — took a look at [Company Name]'s recent [job postings / LinkedIn activity / news] and already have some thoughts on where I might be able to add immediate value.

If the time no longer works, I completely understand. Here's a link to reschedule at your convenience: [Calendly link]

Either way, I'm genuinely looking forward to the conversation and helping you solve [specific pain point they mentioned].

Talk soon,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

P.S. If you'd like me to focus on a specific role during our call, just reply with the job title and I'll come prepared with market intel — salary benchmarks, talent pool size, typical time-to-fill for that position.

Sequence 3: After a Demo/Call No-Show

Email 1 (Day 0 — same day as missed call): Subject: Missed you today — here to reschedule

Hi [First Name],

I was looking forward to our call today at [Time], but it looks like something must have come up on your end — completely understandable.

No frustration here. Life happens, calendars get hijacked, and priorities shift fast.

I'd love to find another time that works better for you. Here are a few options:

- **[Day, Date]** at [Time]

- **[Day, Date]** at [Time]

- **[Day, Date]** at [Time]

Or feel free to grab any open slot here: [Calendly link]

If the timing isn't right at all, just let me know and I'll circle back in a few weeks. Either way, I'm not going anywhere.

Talk soon,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 2 (Day 3): Subject: Still worth a conversation?

Hi [First Name],

I followed up a few days ago after our missed call, but I haven't heard back — so I wanted to check in one more time.

I'm not sure if:

- The timing just isn't right
- The initial problem I mentioned isn't a priority
- Or something else came up entirely

Any of those is a completely valid answer. I just want to make sure I'm not following up when it's not useful.

If you're still open to connecting, even a 10-minute phone call — no screen share, no slides, no sales pitch — would be enough for me to understand whether I can actually help. If I can't, I'll tell you straight up.

Here's a direct link to my calendar: [Calendly link]

Looking forward to hearing from you,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 3 (Day 8): Subject: I'll leave the door open, [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I've reached out a couple of times since our missed call, and I don't want to keep knocking on a door that's closed.

This is my last follow-up for now — but I want to be clear: ****the door is open on my end whenever you're ready.****

In the meantime, I put together a quick resource that might be useful regardless of whether we work together:

****[Resource Title]**** — [e.g., "The 2024 Hiring Benchmark Report for [Their Industry]" or "5 Questions Every Hiring Manager Should Ask Before Partnering with a Recruiter"]

[Link or attachment]

No strings attached. Just something valuable to make these emails worth opening.

When the timing is better, you know where to find me.

Wishing you and the team at [Company Name] continued success.

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

P.S. If there's someone else better suited to have this conversation, I'd genuinely appreciate the introduction. Happy to adjust my approach entirely.

Sequence 4: After Sending a Proposal with No Response

Email 1 (Day 3): Subject: Checking in on the proposal — any questions?

Hi [First Name],

I sent over the proposal for [Company Name] on [Date], and I wanted to make sure it landed in the right place and made sense.

Proposals can raise a lot of questions, and I'd rather answer them now than have something hold up your decision.

A few things prospects often ask me at this stage:

***"Can you negotiate the fee structure?"** — In some cases, yes. Let's talk about what works for your budget.

"How quickly can you realistically start?" — Typically within 48 hours of signing. I often have candidates in my network for roles we've already discussed.

***"What if the hire doesn't work out?"** — My [90-day replacement guarantee] is baked into every engagement. I've never had a client walk away without a resolution.

Is there anything in the proposal that gave you pause? I'd much rather have a frank conversation than lose you to a misunderstanding.

Happy to jump on a 10-minute call this week to walk through it together.

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 2 (Day 7): Subject: One thing I forgot to include in the proposal

Hi [First Name],

I was reviewing the proposal I sent over and realized I left out something that might actually be the most compelling part of working together.

[Client Name / "One of my clients" if you prefer not to name them] came to me in a similar situation to yours — [brief description: e.g., "they'd had a senior engineering role open for 4 months and were losing candidates to larger companies with faster processes"]. Within 19 days of engaging with me, they had a signed offer from a candidate who had 2 other competing offers on the table.

Here's what made the difference: [brief tactical insight — e.g., "We restructured the interview process from 5 rounds to 3 and compressed the timeline from 3 weeks to 8 days. Candidates noticed."]

I have a few ideas like this specifically for [Company Name] that I didn't include in the proposal because they're better explained in conversation.

Would a quick call be worth it this week? I promise it'll be the most useful 20 minutes you spend on hiring this month.

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 3 (Day 14): Subject: Should I close your file?

Hi [First Name],

I've followed up a couple of times since sending the proposal, and I haven't heard back — so I want to be respectful of your time and ask directly:

****Is this something you'd like to move forward with, or should I close out your file for now?****

There's no wrong answer. If the budget shifted, priorities changed, or you went a different direction — I completely understand and I'd appreciate you letting me know so I can stop following up.

If you're still interested but something in the proposal needs to change — the fee structure, the scope, the start date — I'm very open to that conversation.

And if life just got busy and you haven't had a chance to review it, I'm happy to schedule a brief call to walk through the highlights in 10 minutes flat.

Whatever the case, just hit reply and let me know. Even a one-line answer helps me more than silence.

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

P.S. The proposal is attached again for easy reference: [Attachment]

Sequence 5: Re-Engagement After 90 Days of Silence

Email 1 (Day 1 of re-engagement): Subject: It's been a while — a lot has changed

Hi [First Name],

It's been about three months since we last connected, and I've been thinking about [Company Name].

A lot can change in 90 days — teams grow, roles open up, priorities shift. I wanted to reach back out because:

1. ****I have a candidate I think you'd want to meet.**** I've been working with a [job title] who has [brief, compelling description — e.g., "8 years of enterprise SaaS sales experience and a track

record of 140%+ quota attainment"]. They're selectively exploring new opportunities and your company came to mind immediately.

2. ****The market has shifted.**** [Relevant insight — e.g., "Competition for mid-level engineering talent in [their city/remote] has increased significantly, but salary expectations have actually leveled off — which means companies that move decisively right now have a real advantage."]

3. ****I wanted to reconnect.**** Genuinely. I enjoyed our earlier conversations and I'd love to know how things are going for the team.

Is there a role you're trying to fill — or anticipate filling in the next 30-60 days? Even a 10-minute conversation to catch up would be worthwhile.

Good to be back in touch,

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 2 (Day 5): Subject: What's changed at [Company Name] since [Month]?

Hi [First Name],

Quick follow-up to my note earlier this week.

I did a little catch-up on [Company Name] and noticed [specific observation — e.g., "you've posted 3 new roles in the last 30 days" / "you recently announced a new product line" / "your team has grown to X employees on LinkedIn"].

That usually signals one of two things: things are going really well and you're scaling, or there's pressure to grow faster than your internal recruiting can keep up with.

Either way — I'd love to hear the story from your side.

What's the biggest hiring challenge you're working through right now? I promise this isn't a pitch. I'm genuinely curious, and if I can offer any useful perspective — based on what I'm seeing across the [their industry] market — I'm happy to do that with zero strings attached.

Reply here or grab 15 minutes on my calendar: [Calendly link]

[Your Name]

[Title] | [Company]

[Phone] | [LinkedIn URL]

Email 3 (Day 12): Subject: Last note for now — but I mean it this time

Hi [First Name],

Third and final outreach — I promise I mean it this time.

I know re-engagement emails can feel like noise, especially from someone you haven't worked with. So I want to be upfront:

****If the timing isn't right, I'm not the right fit, or you've found a recruiting solution that's working — that's genuinely great news.**** I'd rather you be in good shape than feel obligated to respond to my emails.

But if any of these sound familiar right now:

- You have a role that's been dragging on too long
- Your internal team is stretched thin and good candidates are slipping
- You've had a bad experience with a recruiter before and you're hesitant to try again

...then I'd really encourage you to give me 15 minutes. Not because I'll close you on a deal, but because I think I can give you a different experience than what you've had before.

Here's my calendar: [Calendly link]

And here's something useful to take with you either way: [Link to resource — market salary guide, hiring checklist, case study, etc.]

It was great connecting earlier this